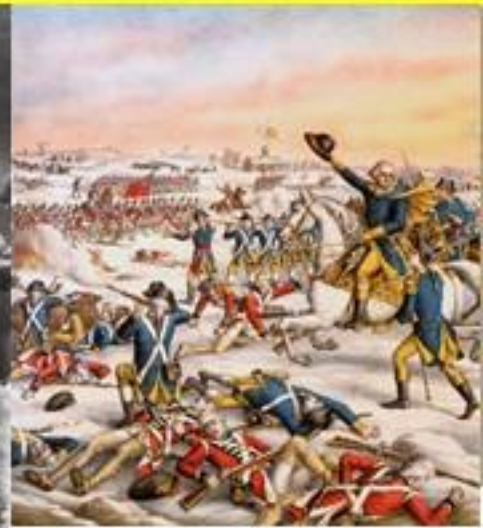


WORLD HISTORY



MODULE – 40

THE COLD WAR - 2

THE CUBAN MISSILE CRISIS (1962)

1 The Soviet Union stationed her nuclear missiles in Cuba, which was a communist country and Soviet ally.

2 The U.S.A. considered this as a great threat to her security.

3 John F. Kennedy sent the 7th Nuclear fleet towards Cuba.

4 This literally brought the two super-powers to the verge of war.

5 However, the good sense prevailed on both the sides and the crisis was averted.

6 Subsequently, the U.S.S.R. dismantled missiles in Cuba.



DECLINE OF COLD WAR – DÉTENTE (REDUCTION OF TENSION)

- 1 After 1960, the U.S.A. and the U.S.S.R. had developed equality in nuclear weapons.
- 2 Thus any nuclear war would lead to co-destruction.
- 3 This awareness led both the super powers to believe in the inevitability of peaceful co-existence.
- 4 They were, therefore, prompted to conclude the Nuclear Test Ban Treaty in 1963.

- 5 This treaty was followed by a 'Hot Line Agreement' between Washington and Kremlin.



DECLINE OF COLD WAR – DÉTENTE (REDUCTION OF TENSION)

6 After the 1970s, the friction between the Soviet Union and Communist China led to Sino-Soviet rift.

7 The People's Republic of China was admitted into the UN.

8 President Nixon of U.S.A. visited Moscow in May 1972 and concluded the SALT -I Treaty (Strategic Arms Limitation Treaty).

9 In June 1973, Brezhnev paid a nine-day visit to the United States and further progress was made in the direction of strategic arms limitation.

10 This reduction of tension between the U.S.A. and U.S.S.R. is known as era of détente.



- 1 With the disintegration of the Soviet Union, the collapse of Communism in the Soviet Union and Eastern Europe occurred.
- 2 The bi-polar world became unipolar world.
- 3 On 31st July 1991, American President George Bush and Soviet leader Michael Gorbachev signed the 'historic' START - I Treaty in the Moscow Summit.
- 4 This marks the end of the Era of Cold War.
- 5 The ideological war otherwise known as Cold War was fought for about five decades since 1945.



- 6 The world saw the vertical division of nation states.
- 7 Military alliances were made. Arms race developed.
- 8 Nuclear holocaust threatened the world on many occasions.
- 9 However, after the 1970s détente resulted in the gradual relaxation of tension between the two super powers which ultimately ended with the dissolution of Soviet Union.



- During the cold war on many local and regional issues the two superpowers took opposite and hostile stand to extend their sphere of influence.
- Another important purposes of the superpowers to get engaged in the local wars and disputes were containment of the other.
- The following events proved to be the theatres of Cold war



YEAR	EVENT	REMARKS
1949	Chinese Revolution	- US and its allies supported counter Revolution forces under Chiang Kai Shek to prevent the success of communist revolution in china. - They failed to prevent the rise of communism in china.
1950	Korean War	USSR and China supported North Korea, while USA and its allies supported South Korea in the Korean War.
1955-75	Vietnam War	The Vietnam War was the prolonged struggle between nationalist forces attempting to unify the country of Vietnam under a communist government and the United States(with the aid of the South Vietnamese) attempting to prevent the spread of communism.

YEAR	EVENT	REMARKS
1958	Berlin Blockade	- After the fall of Hitler, Germany was divided into four zones and was given to USA, USSR, France and Britain. - The German capital of Berlin was to be divided into four sectors however it was located deep inside the soviet zone. - In 1948 USA, France and Britain soon integrated their zones as West Germany and issued common currency. - These nations soon started propaganda to integrate the fourth zone from the influence of USSR. - In retaliation the soviets issued orders restricting western military and passenger traffic between American, British and French occupation zones and Berlin. - This is Berlin Blockade.

YEAR	EVENT	REMARKS
1962	Cuban Missile Crisis	- In 1962, the Soviet Union was desperately behind the United States in the arms race. - Soviet missiles were only powerful enough to be launched against Europe but U.S. missiles were capable of striking the entire Soviet Union. - In 1962, Soviet Union placed intermediate-range missiles in Cuba which threatened USA.
1979-89	Soviet-Afghan War	- The soviet war in Afghanistan lasted nine years from December 1979 to February 1989. - Part of the Cold war, it was fought between Soviet-led Afghan forces against multi-national insurgent groups called the Mujahedeen. - The latter received billions of dollar support from United States.

- The following strategies were used by the two superpowers during the Cold war to extend their hegemony:

1 FOREIGN AID

- The two superpowers tried to win allies by giving financial aid to other nations.
- **Example:** Egypt took aid from the Soviet Union to build the Aswan High Dam.

2 PROPAGANDA

- Both superpowers used propaganda to try to win support overseas.
- **Example:** Radio Free Europe broadcast programs about the rest of the World into Eastern Europe.

3 ESPIONAGE

- Fearing the enemy might be gaining the advantage, each side spied on the other.
- **Example:** U-2spy planes from U.S. one was shot down by the soviets in 1960.



4 BRINKMANSHIP

- The policy of brinkmanship meant going to the brink of war to make the other side back down.
- **Example:** Cuban Missile Crisis

5 MULTINATIONAL ALLIANCES

- To gain the support of other nations, both the Soviet Union and U.S. entered into alliances.
- **Example:** NATO and the Warsaw pact.

6 SURROGATE WARS

- The word surrogate means substitute.
- Although the U.S. and the Soviet Union did not fight against each other directly, they fought indirectly by backing opposing sides in many smaller conflicts.
- **Example:** Korean Conflict, Vietnam war, Chinese Revolution, Cuban Revolution, Civil War in Nicaragua, Conflict in Iran, Soviet-Afghan war.



QUESTIONS FOR PRACTICE

1. Analyse the importance of spheres of interest for one of the superpowers in the Cold War.
150 Words
2. The Cold War was caused by fear, not aggression. Elaborate.
150 words
3. Give an account of the formation of Military blocs during the Cold War?
150 Words

WE EXPRESS OUR
SINCERE THANKS
FOR VIEWING THIS VIDEO

Presented by



Learning Space

For Suggestions:

suggestions@learningspace.in

To Contact us:

info@learningspace.in

For Information:

info.learningspacedigital@gmail.com

Visit us at:

www.learningspacedigital.com

0866 244 44 72

98499 42299

94415 27588